# WHY EVERYONE USES REACT

Facebook's notification bug led to React. Describe the screen; React keeps it updated.

## THE PROBLEM

Before React, developers updated pages by hand (jQuery era). In big apps one part updated, another didn't, and the screen went **out of sync**.

## THE IDEA (2013)

You describe what the screen should look like for the current data. React updates it for you.

## COMPONENTS = LEGO PIECES

```
function LikeButton() {
  const [likes, setLikes] = useState(0);
  return (
    <button onClick={() => setLikes(likes + 1)}>
      {likes}
    </button>
  );
}
// Reuse <LikeButton /> anywhere. Change the data once,
// every place that shows it updates automatically.
```

## ALTERNATIVES

| Tool | Note |
|---|---|
| Vue | Gentle learning curve |
| Svelte | Compiles away, very light |
| Angular | Full framework by Google |

## TRY IT YOURSELF

```
npm create vite@latest my-app -- --template react
cd my-app && npm install && npm run dev
```



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